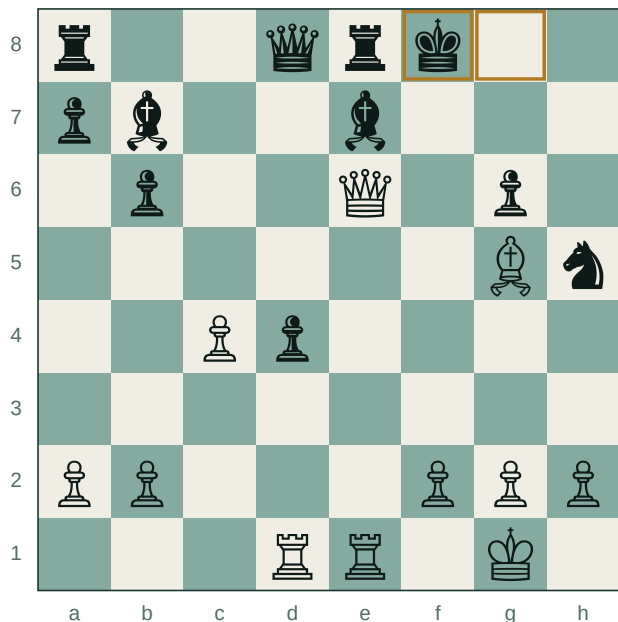


Pins and pressure: White, move 21

Pins and pressure

White to move



Previous move: 20...Kf8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21. Bh6+ Ng7 22. Qxg6 Bf6 23. Rxe8+ Qxe8 24. Qxf6+

21.Bh6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **21...Ng7**.

22.Qxg6 The queen captures the pawn on g6. From g6 it attacks rook on e8 and knight on g7. Recorded reply: **22...Bf6**.

23.Rxe8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From e8 it attacks king on f8 and queen on d8. Recorded reply: **23...Qxe8**.

24.Qxf6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From f6 it attacks king on f8 and knight on g7.

At the end, nominal material is White 23 / Black 23 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -4 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on f8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b7. Check for tactical protection.